

General Education

SOCIAL STUDIES

Major Forms of Government

Systems of Government

1. Unitary System

- A central government that holds all legitimate power.
- There is little or no sphere of government autonomy to local or component units like the provinces, barangays and cities in the Philippines.
- The central government is given all authority to make all policies, although it may deputize other governmental structures to act on its behalf.
- Political power is more centralized (concentrated ore on central authority) in unitary than federal systems.

Systems of Government

1. Unitary System

- ***Advantage*** – In this kind of government there is clear hierarchical authority.
- ***Disadvantage*** – For the reason that the loyalty of the citizens is focused on the governmental authority, citizens tend to identify with the country as a whole rather than with regional authorities.

Systems of Government

2. Federal State

- a. Local governmental authorities are set-up by the constitution and these authorities are given certain political decisions over which they have a legal monopoly of control.
- b. A federal government is one in which government powers are divided between the central government and its local government units as specified in the constitution of the state.

Systems of Government

2. Federal State

- c. In contrast to a unitary state, there is an explicit sharing of power among levels of government in a federation, and no level has legal power to dominate any other level in policy domains.
- d. The essence of federation is coordination not hierarchy.

Systems of Government

2. Federal State

- ***Advantage*** – Central or local government is independent in its sphere of jurisdiction.
- ***Disadvantage*** – There is a duplication of offices and personnel in central and local government, and to maintain this would be a heavy financial burden to the government.

Systems of Government

3. Confederation

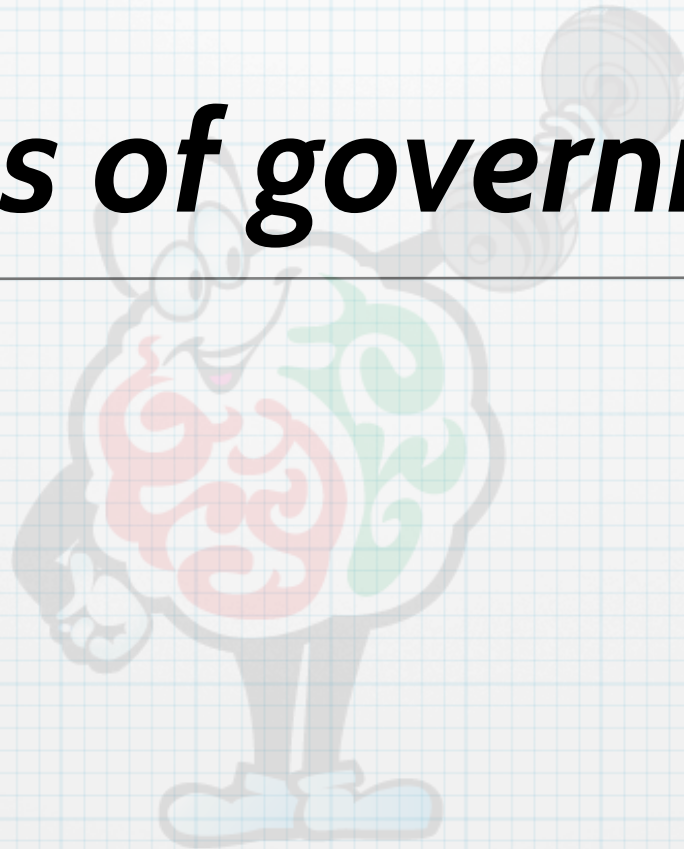
- This is an association wherein states delegate certain power to a supranational central government but retain primary power.
 - Examples: *United Nations, European Union, ASEAN, APEC, United Arab Emirates*

Form of Distribution	Strengths	Weaknesses
Unitary	• Clear authority • Decisive control • No stalemates between center and periphery	• Hyper-concentration of power • Weak representation of diversity and minorities
Federal	• Diversity represented • Checks on center's power • Unity created	• Duplication and overlap of power • Conflicts over ultimate power • Slow process, compromise
Confederation	• Facilitation of cooperation • Power retained by sub-units	• Conditional compliance • Instability • Limited power

Key Terms

- **DECENTRALIZATION** – the transfer of powers from central government to lower levels in a political-administrative and territorial hierarchy
- **DEVOLUTION** – the transfer of “*natural resource management to local individuals and institutions’ located within and outside of government*”
- **DECONCENTRATION** – the process by which the agents of central government control are relocated and geographically dispersed

Forms of government

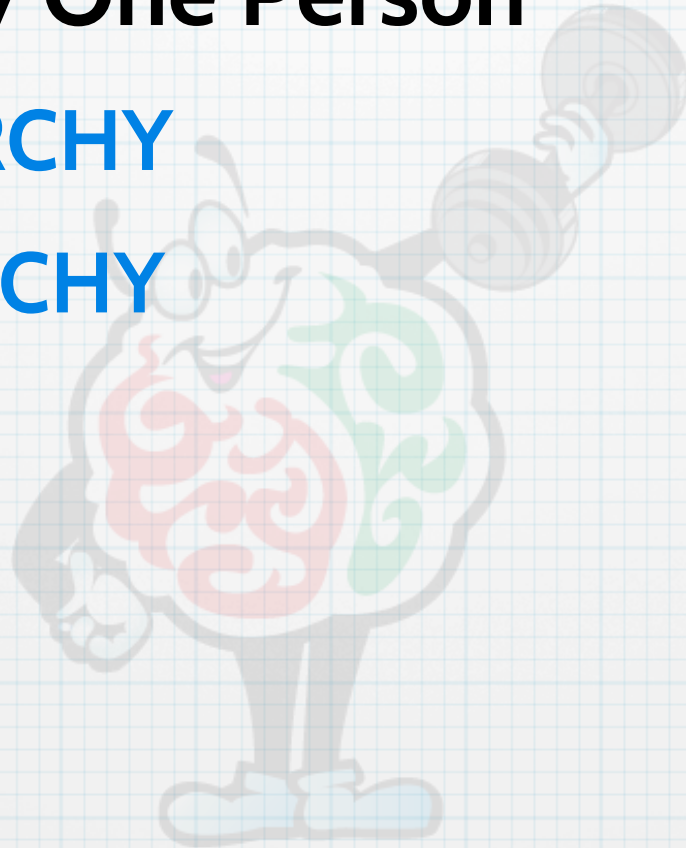


Forms of Government

I. Ruled by One Person

A. MONARCHY

B. OLIGARCHY



Forms of Government

A. MONARCHY

- A government that has a single person who is generally considered the ruler by the title and birthright. Titles include: Czar, King, Queen, Emperor, Caesar, etc.
- Power is absolute and is either taken through conquest or passed down to family members without regard for ability or appropriateness.
- Society is formed around feudal groups or tribes in which the ruling family delegates power and authority based upon the desires of a single individual.

Forms of Government

A. MONARCHY

- a. ***Absolute Monarchy*** - The monarch exercises absolute power and wields executive, legislative and judicial powers (predominated in France).
- b. ***Limited Monarchy*** - The monarch delegates powers. For example, the legislative body, judicial power by the court and executive power by the King / Queen exercise legislative power. They rule according to their constitution. (United Kingdom, Belgium, the Netherlands, Japan, Spain)

Forms of Government

B. DICTATORSHIP

- A type of government controlled by a single individual and giving the people little or no individual freedom.
- Typically a person who rules by threat of force.
- People who are loyal to a dictatorship swear allegiance to the person first and the country second.
- Fascism, Theocracies, Monarchies and Communism can all be dictatorships.

Forms of Government

B. DICTATORSHIP

- A Republic cannot be a dictatorship.
- This can be applicable during a period of chaos or discontent when the leader seeks emergency powers to implement policies.
- Can also be used by a leader to remain in office and maintain power.

Forms of Government

B. DICTATORSHIP

1. ***Authoritarianism*** – The political actions and decisions of the ruler are not constrained, while political rights and freedoms of the citizens are significantly limited.
2. ***Totalitarianism*** – Under this type of regime, government uses ideology to captivate people's loyalty to the leader-dictator. The totalitarian dictator wields absolute power. The use of coercion, violence and force is a tool to maintain obedience from the people.

Forms of Government

B. DICTATORSHIP

Characteristics of Totalitarianism

- As a form of government the totalitarian dictatorship is built on an ideological foundation. Government utilizes ideology to captivate the people's belief and loyalty to the leader-dictator. A totalitarian leader wields absolute power.
- The use of force, violent coercion and terrorism to control the people.
- Centralized control by the government of the nation's economy. **Everyone** must conform and accept the policies of the dictatorship.

Forms of Government

B. DICTATORSHIP

Characteristics of Totalitarianism

- To maximize the effectiveness of terror as a means of mass control, the government controls all means of communication and propaganda (eg. Soviet Union)
- Totalitarianism is also centralized control by the government's economy. Every business enterprise is regulated, coordinated by the existing regime.
- Examples: ***Nazism*** - Adolf Hitler, ***Fascism*** - Benito Mussolini, ***Chinese Communism*** - Mao Tze Tung

Forms of Government

II. Ruled by the Few

A. ARISTOCRACY

Derived from the Greek etymology “Aristo” which means the “best” and “Kratia or Kratos” which means rule. A government by the “best members of the community. Aristocrats are presumably men of the highest intelligence and integrity. They belong to the elite in society. Their social status, wealth and political power are inherited.

Forms of Government

II. Ruled by the Few

B. OLIGARCHY

This is also a government of a wealthy few but they do not come from nobility like aristocrats. Oligarchs believe that the most important requisites to claim of power are wealth, good social positions and education; it is unlikely that oligarchy could serve the interest of the masses since they use their positions in the government for their personal benefit. They build economic empires for themselves and their family.

Forms of Government

III. Ruled by Many

DEMOCRACY

“Demos” derived from the Greek term for people and “kratos” which means rule. The Constitution guarantees freedom of speech, freedom of association, freedom of religion and freedom of expression.

Forms of Government

III. Ruled by Many

Two essential features of Democracy:

1. **Majority Rule** - the majority of citizens choose their leaders who then have the mandate to govern and make public policies.
2. **Minority Rights** - This is ensured so long as the minority of citizens openly attempts to win majority support for leaders and policies without loss of individual rights just as the majority enjoys these rights.

Forms of Government

III. Ruled by Many

A democracy is made to work when the following interact:

1. **Citizens** - Active participation of the citizenry is necessary in order to prevent government from committing abuses. Citizens can help to balance between power and authority of government officials. Citizens should exercise their freedom and rights within the bounds of the Constitution and the law, just as government should exercise its authority within limits.
2. **Suffrage and the Electoral Process** - Suffrage is the right conferred by law upon a qualified group of citizens to choose their public officials and to participate in the determination of proposed policies whenever these policies are submitted to them for approval. The citizens must use this right to elect qualified people who can govern competently and responsibly.

Forms of Government

III. Ruled by Many

A democracy is made to work when the following interact:

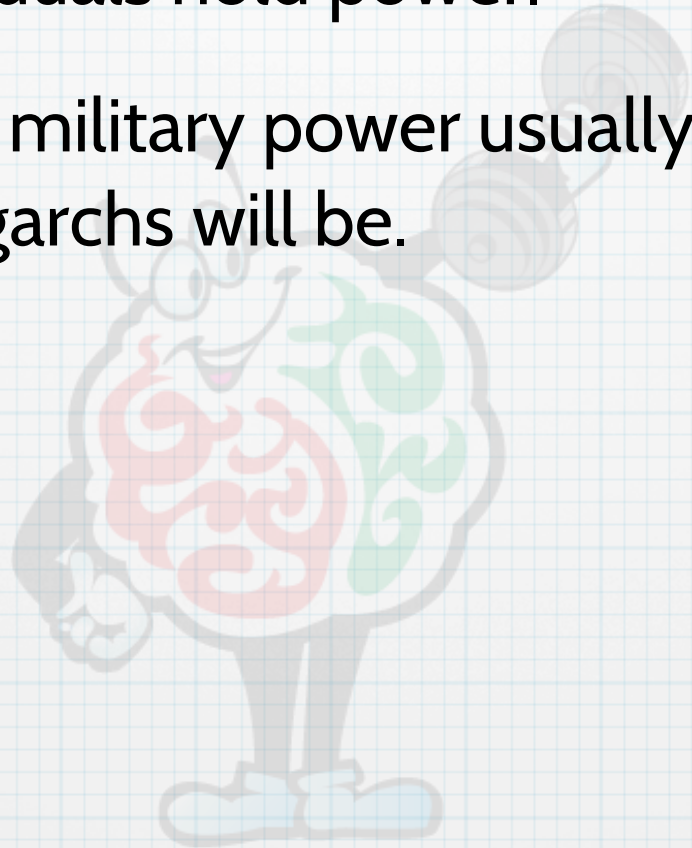
3. **Political Parties** - Intertwined with democratic government, this is a group of officials or would-be officials who are linked with a sizable group of citizens into an organization; a chief object of this organization is to ensure that its officials attain power or are maintained in power. The party's nature as a structure, tying together a large group of officials and citizens, provides an avenue by which one part may control or communicate with another. It is this that has made it such a versatile tool of modern politics.
4. **Interest Groups** - is an organized group of citizens one of whose goals is to ensure that the state follows. They aim to represent public opinion and having it heard in an organized and effective way to government authorities.

Autocracy

- A single person holds power.
- Power is usually inherited or kept by force, i.e. dictatorships and monarchies.
- Government by a single person having unlimited power; despotism (*domination through threat of punishment and violence*)

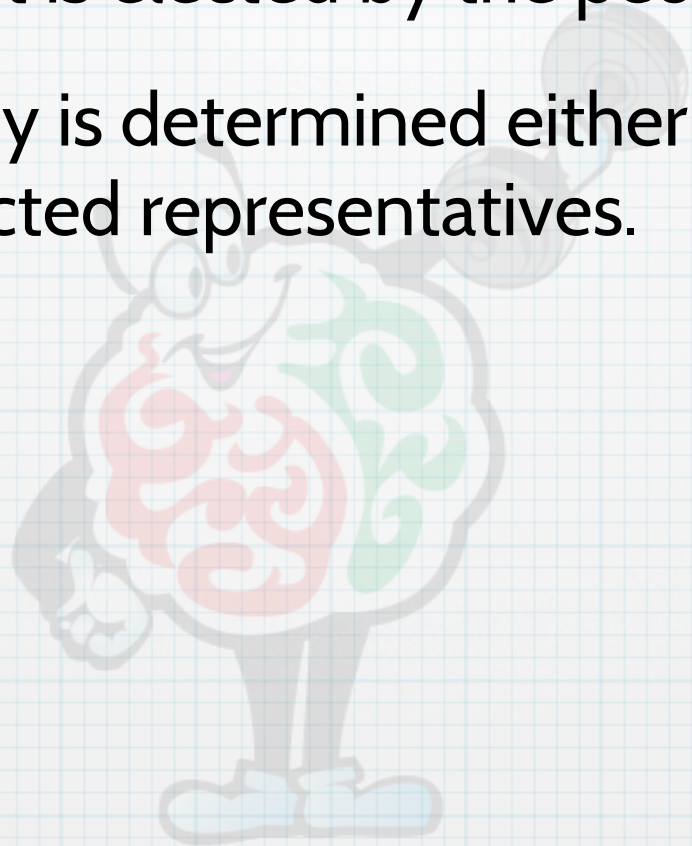
Oligarchy

- A few individuals hold power.
- Wealth and military power usually influence who the oligarchs will be.



Democracy

- Government is elected by the people.
- A democracy is determined either directly or through elected representatives.

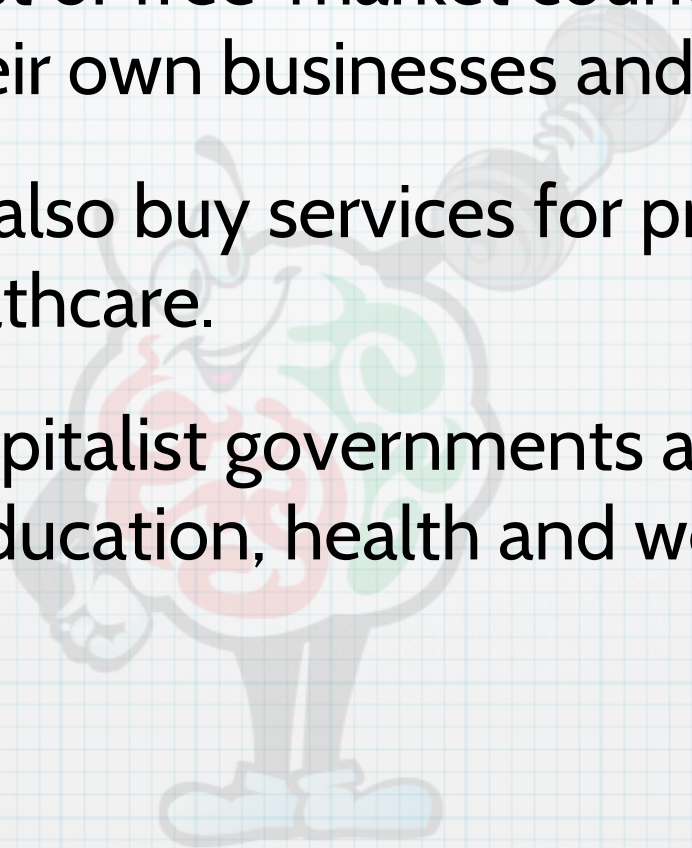


Anarchy

- A situation where there is **no government**.
- This can happen after a civil war in a country, when a government has been destroyed and rival groups are fighting to take its place.
- Anarchists are people who believe that government is a bad thing in that it stops people organizing their own lives

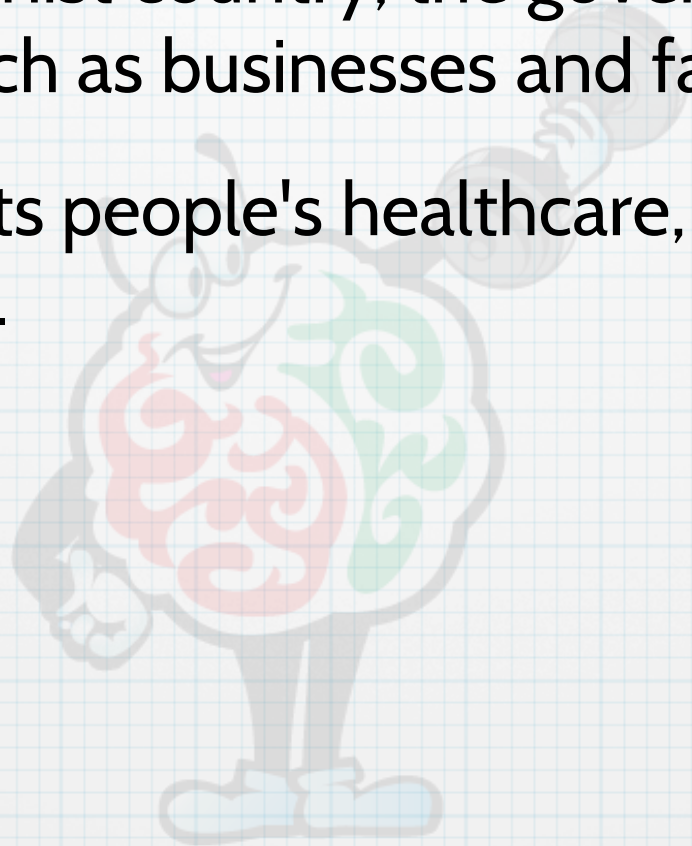
Capitalist

- In a capitalist or free-market country, people can own their own businesses and property.
- People can also buy services for private use, such as healthcare.
- But most capitalist governments also provide their own education, health and welfare services.



Communist

- In a communist country, the government owns property such as businesses and farms.
- It provides its people's healthcare, education and welfare.



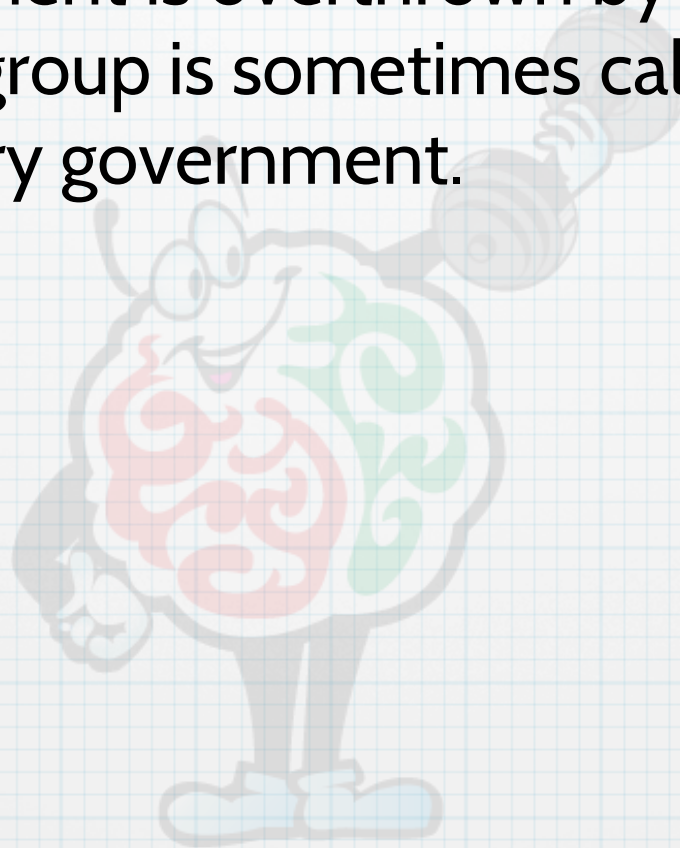
Republic

- A republic is a country that has no monarch.
- The head of the country is usually an elected president.

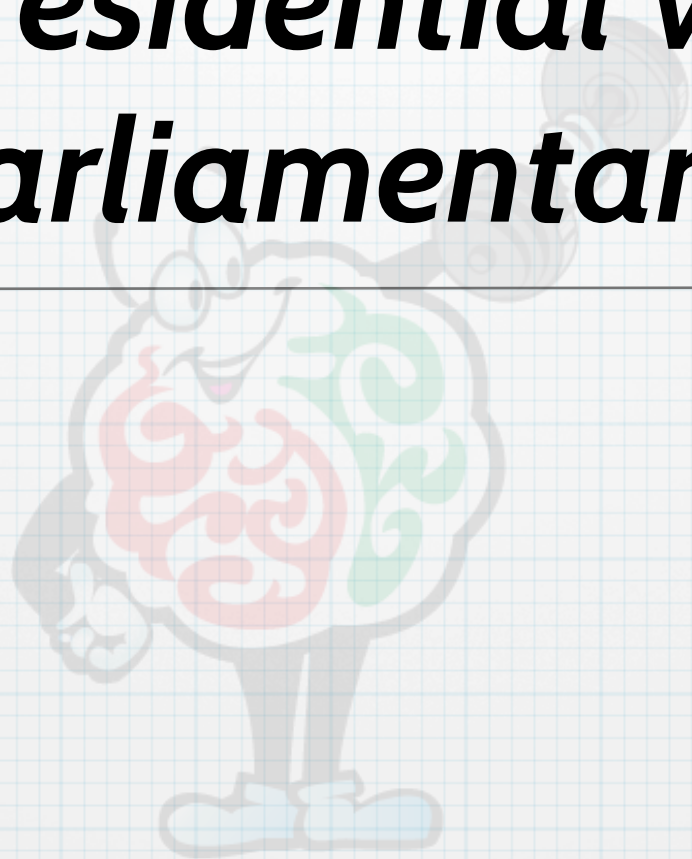


Revolutionary

- If a government is overthrown by force, the new ruling group is sometimes called a revolutionary government.



Presidential vs Parliamentary



Presidential System

- The executive power is exercised by a single **president** elected by popular vote.
- S/he holds office for a specific period of time fixed by the constitution of the state.
- S/he appoints the members of his / her cabinet who are responsible to the president. Their service is co-terminus with the presidents.

Presidential System

- An essential element of this system is the **separation of powers of the executive, legislative, and judicial branches**, which is made more effective by checks and balances of the 3 branches.
- This is the form of government of the United States and the Philippines.

Parliamentary System

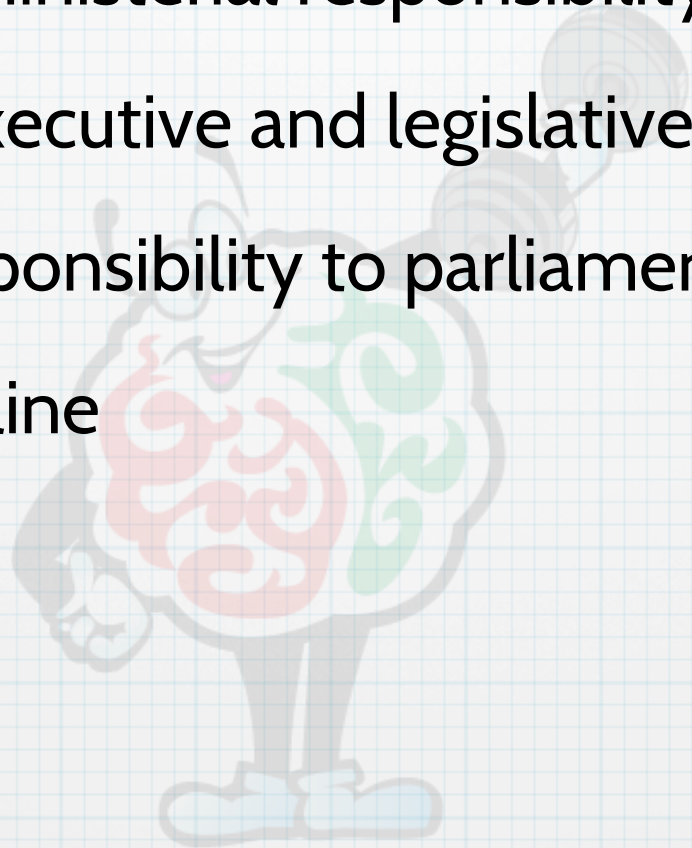
- Executive power belongs to the **Prime Minister** and his Cabinet. They are the leaders of the majority party in the **Parliament** and they remain in office as long as they have the confidence and support of the parliamentary majority.
- They participate in parliamentary debates and defend their policies and bills, and see to it that they are approved for the nations welfare and for their respective constituents, since they are also elected as members of parliament.

Parliamentary System

- They are responsible to Parliament for their acts and decisions as members of the Cabinet.
- The Prime Minister and his cabinet are removable by Parliament by means of parliamentary censure on the members of the cabinet and a no-confidence vote against the Prime Minister.

Parliamentary System

1. Collective ministerial responsibility
2. Fusion of executive and legislative power
3. Cabinet responsibility to parliament
4. Party discipline



Presidential VS Parliamentary

